



Now even seats in sync

In a corny technological advance, theater seats for Terminator are being retrofitted to move "in perfect sync" with the onscreen action



Bento

The iPhone app that lets you sync address book, mail and calendar data, is named after the Japanese word for compartmentalised Lunch Boxes

Feature

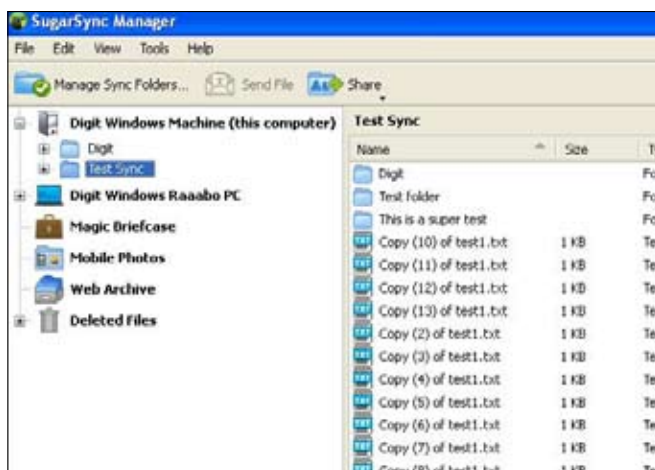
connect to those folders to execute a sync. Although you need to download the application, the interface is mostly web-based and you can connect to your Live Desktop through your browser when you need to access your mesh from the web. Your mesh includes any devices that you add, and the folders you choose to sync and share. Using this service is a little complicated, but it is powerful. It will integrate into your Windows Explorer and give you a new option in the right-click menu to add any file or folder to the mesh.

Once folders and files have been added to the mesh, they sync automatically. If you want to view your files online without downloading the client, head over to the Live Desktop. Files renamed, edited or deleted in the mesh will automatically be reflected in all devices connected to the mesh. To alter the synchronisation settings of any folder simply right-click on it through the web interface and go to Settings. You can specify settings for the relevant devices that you will synchronise, and when to sync; for example, "sync only those files modified in the last 30 days." Connecting to a PC remotely, however, requires ActiveX controls. As far as limitations go — this software is available for Mac and Windows only; it also has a data cap of 5GB which should be sufficient for most users looking to sync important documents.

SugarSync [sugarsync.com]

For the power user

Once you register and install this powerful tool, your SugarSync account will be created and your computer added to it. After this it will ask you to specify the folders that you want to sync. SugarSync is configured to display the status of files and folders directly in Windows Explorer via an icon overlay. The folders you select will be backed up to the SugarSync server from where they will be available for remote access through any browser, on any computer. Install the client on multiple computers to automatically sync files between them. The trial version of this software comes with a 10 GB limit and expires after 45 days. A feature very unique to SugarSync is its ability to sync with mobile devices. It has applications for the iPhone, Blackberry and Windows Mobile platforms. Besides, you can always visit m.sugarsync.com from any WAP-enabled phone. Even through WAP, this application retains most of its functionality. Using the online interface, you can click on any file to access options for available actions. These include the ability to edit text files with WebSync, which opens a Java-based auto-updater to update changes on the fly. You can even directly email files as attachments or check out version history. All-in-all, a robust solution for the power user. It will set you back by \$50 a year for a 30 GB package.



SugarSync Interface: one look should tell you that this is a syncing solution for the power user

SHARE LARGE FILES

Many of these syncing services allow you to share large files with others. These files are obviously too large to be sent via email. There are, however, standalone services that are meant specifically for this purpose.

www.Drop.io - Head over to this file sharing website for a simple and easy way to share files and collaborate with others. Its easy; simply create a "drop" in two clicks and get going. The site allows

for real-time collaboration with features like chat, adding multiple files and notes to a drop. An email address is also created for a drop. Any mail attachments sent to the id will automatically be added to the drop.

www.Yousendit.com - Perfect for the occasional sending of large files. This free service covers file sizes up to 100mb and doesn't require registration.

Dropbox [getdropbox.com] Best of both worlds

Dropbox lets you sync files online as well as across computers and like some of the other solutions, it even has a web interface. So, what's the big deal? The big deal is that it also has support for the Linux world! The service lets you sync seamlessly between Mac, Windows and Linux; none of the other featured services offer this. Dropbox maintains a good balance between ease of use and availability of advanced features.

It makes use of an incremental sync process which means that only those parts of a file that have changed are uploaded each time. So you

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